

HELP BEETHOVEN IS THE MUSIC TEACHER!

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THE FIRST DAY OF SCHOOL

It was the first day of school and I was sitting at my desk listening to the teacher. Her name was Mrs. Smith and she was about 25 years old and she had blue eyes and curly blonde hair. I liked her very much. Anyway we were working on our math when Mrs. Smith said, "Class, please stop what you are doing. It is time for library." So we went to library where we had a really nice librarian named Mrs. Brown. When library was over it was time for lunch. It was fried chicken with pineapple on the side. Yum my favorite. After lunch it was time for gym class.

GYM CLASS

When we got into the gym we sat down and listened to the teacher his name was Mr. Diffin and he was very tall. He said we would do warm ups and then play a game. So we did warm ups and we played a game and did cool downs left the gym. Now it was time for music.

THE MUSIC TEACHER

I was waiting at the music room door. It was open but we had to wait. Finally we were allowed inside. But when I saw the music teacher I stopped dead in my tracks. I couldn't believe my eyes. My friend Emily asked what the matter was and I said, "That's no ordinary man. That's Ludwig Van Beethoven!"

MUSIC CLASS

Then Mrs. Smith said, “Julia go in the music room. You are wasting time.” So I went in, even if I didn’t want to. I sat down waiting for grump face to talk. Finally he said, “Class you are in the third grade and it is time you learned recorders. “Then he handed out brand new plastic recorders. I was surprised at this and said thank you 5 times. He smiled. Then he taught us how to play 4 notes, e, b, g and a. Then he gave us the music to hot cross buns and said, “Class we have only 5 minutes of learning time left. What I would like you to do is practice this song and next Tuesday play it for me. Now you have to leave.”

THE AFTERNOON

The afternoon went fine that day and I have a list of the things we did. Writing science recess reading. Then it was time to go home. When I got to the bus who was there but the music teacher. I tried to ignore him but he said, “Hello. Aren’t you in the class I taught after gym?” “Yes” I said, “Why are you afraid of me?,” he asked. I didn’t answer. I just got on the bus leaving Beethoven waiting for an answer.

HOME AT LAST

When I got home my little brother Michael was waiting for me. Then my mom asked, “How was your first day of school?” “Fine,” I said, “Just fine.” “What did you do?” She asked. So I told her about my day. But I didn’t say a word about Beethoven.

DINNER

When my dad got home it was time for dinner. It was spaghetti. Yuck, I was sick of it. At the dinner table we talked about my first day of school (all except Michael). But I still didn’t say a word about Beethoven.

BEDTIME

After dinner, we watched News Wheel Of Fortune and Jeopardy. Then I did homework. Then it was bedtime. I went in the bathroom, brushed my teeth, washed my face, got on my nightgown, read a chapter in my book, and turned out my light (Ignoring Michael). Then I figured out that I was listening to Beethoven's 9th symphony. That reminded me of the music teacher. Then I fell asleep.

THE DREAM

That night I dreamed that Beethoven climbed into the house, took me out of my bed, and tormented me. Then he took me to his house and never gave me back. He even kept me in a cage and let me listen to his music-only. Then I woke up.

SCHOOL AGAIN

When I got downstairs, my mom had A bowl of Cream of Wheat waiting for me. I dug in. Then I was off to school and to Beethoven. And that's just who I saw when I got there. But I ignored him even though he said, "Why are you afraid of me?" 6 times. I just walked into Mrs. Smith's room and started math. After math it was computer time.

COMPUTER TIME

We were in the computer lab working on invitations to back to school night. The people who were finished could use any program they wanted. When I was done we had 15 more minutes of computer time left. So I turned on Carmen Sandiego and caught 3 crooks and had 5 more cases till my next promotion. Then it was time for lunch.

LUNCH

At lunch my friend Elle made up songs about Ronald & Mark called big mouth and pinocchio boy. We were eating salad with bread and 2% milk. After lunch it was time for recess.

RECESS

On the playground me and Elle played in and out (obstacle and bravery addition) and talked about music. I still didn't mention Beethoven. But after 5 minutes of conversation Elle could tell I had a secret and insisted on hearing it.

ALL ABOUT BEETHOVEN

So I began my story. "Well it all started yesterday when I was walking into the music room and saw the music teacher." "What's wrong with him?" said Elle. "Elle, can you let me go on?" "Yes" "OK. You see I have a book with the painting of all the great composers that I look at alot. So when I saw the music teacher I immediately identified him as Ludwig Van Beethoven." "You mean that we actually have a great composer in the school?" "Yes." Anyway, I was very surprised when he was so nice to us. Later at the bus, he asked me why I was afraid of him but I didn't answer. This morning he did the same thing. Then we were silent but Elle soon broke it. "Oh no we have music in 30 minutes!" "Who cares." Then we started playing again.

MUSIC AGAIN

After 30 minutes we were on the way to the music room. This time Beethoven let us in right away and began the lesson. It was about musical symbols and signs. First he taught us about the treble and bass clef then about quarter, half and whole notes. Then about bar lines double bar lines and repeat signs. Then he taught us the musical alphabet. Then he handed out music activity books and

staff paper books. Then he told us to do 2 activities in our activity books. Then we left.

THE MEETING

When we got back to the classroom we could do centers, but instead of playing, I got Elle and Emily together and I talked to them. First I told my story and then said we would have to trick the music teacher into saying his true identity out loud in front of the whole class(teacher too). So first Emily would try and get it wrong, the same with Elle. Then I would try and get it right and make him so mad that he would rewrite Rondo a capriccio and play it as loud as he could. That would blow his cover. We decided to stick to that plan.

COVER, BLOWN!

When we were in music class the next day sir grump asked where Chopin was born and Emily raised her hand and said, "I know, it's Germany." "No," said sir grump. Next Elle raised her hand and said, "China? Is it China? It has to be China," but sir grump shook his head and said, "No." Then I raised my hand and said, "Poland." And then I said, "I know who you really are." "Who?", said sir grump. "Ludwig Van Beethoven." And that got him so mad then that instead of writing Rondo a capriccio he wrote the whole 5 th symphony and said, "I can't believe you but you have blown my cover." Then Michelle said, "You mean our music teacher is actually a very famous composer and we didn't know it?" "Yes," I said, "But I already knew." Then everybody started to ask Beethoven how he got here so he said, "Quiet! Now listen and I will tell my story."

BEETHOVEN'S STORY

So Beethoven began his story. “Well,” he said, “Not that long ago, I was stuck inside this stupid book called Great Composers, and whenever its owner didn’t have it opened, it was pitch black and I couldn’t see a thing. One night the owner opened the book to Mozart’s page and put a little of her mom’s book potion on him and said, ‘I wish you would come out of the book.’ Fortunately, some of the potion slipped onto me. Also the owner got some potion on herself and turned into a bird. That night me and Mozart snuck out of the book and went to sleep. In the morning the owner discovered Mozart and that she was a bird. Anyway, I needed a job so I looked around and when I found out that your school needed a music teacher, I said that I would take the job. And that’s where I am now. And that’s my story.” “Bravo! Bravo! Bravis-simo!” shouted the class.

EPILOGUE

Now I am a teacher teaching third grade GT. But at this moment, I have a special guest who is a true friend—Beethoven, who started this in the first place. I wouldn’t have been able to write this book if he had never come along. So I give him three cheers, “Hip! Hip! Hooray!”

PS. Beethoven, if you ever read this book please let me know.

Yours truly,

Julia Catherine Lozos

T H E E N D .
